Ariadne

Still in beta at time of writing, Ariadne is a Web application framework from Muze, a development agency in the Netherlands. It is available under the GNU Public License. Auke van Slooten leads the project.

Ariadne stores PHP source code as objects in a MySQL database. These objects interact with each other using a virtual file system. A rich user interface is presented to the user through Web pages, but advanced users may dig deeper, as well. Another major component controls access rights for users or groups.

Preserving State and Providing Security

You may wish to secure your Web application by requiring visitors to identify themselves with a login and password. Requiring this page after page, though, would be very annoying. You may even want to track users through the site without actually identifying them. The process should be invisible and should not intrude on the experience.

One solution is to generate a random session identifier. This identifier must not be easy to guess and must be unique to each user. The session could be stored in a database or a file and passed in every link or form. The site simply checks that the session is valid each time a page is requested. If the session is invalid, you may display an error message, send the user back to the login page, or just generate a new session identifier, depending on context.

In a site that requires users to log in, the **session identifier** will be associated with a user identifier, which would be the key to a table of user information. You may also keep track of the last time the session requested a page and have all those with no activity in a given period, perhaps 15 minutes, expire. This protects users who walk away from their computers without explicitly logging out.

You may also choose to associate arbitrary variables with each session. This is relatively easy to implement with a relational database. Create a table where each row is uniquely identified by session identifier and variable name. Creating a variable is as easy as inserting a row into the table. You can

Keyword

Session identifier is a piece of data that is used in network communications to identify a session, a series of related message exchanges